

Toilet Repair, Replace & Bidet Installation

The Ultimate Beginner's Guide to Bathroom Independence

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Introduction

The toilet is the most essential seat in the house, yet it's the one we fear fixing the most. Most people see a puddle on the floor or hear a phantom "flush" in the middle of the night and immediately reach for the phone to call a plumber.

Here is the truth: A toilet is a very simple machine. It uses gravity and a few rubber seals to do its job. Almost everything that can go wrong with a toilet can be fixed with a \$15 part and 20 minutes of your time. This guide will walk you through everything from stopping that annoying "running" sound to completely replacing the unit and even upgrading to a modern bidet.

Tools and Materials You'll Need

- **Adjustable Wrench:** For supply lines and floor bolts.
- **Screwdrivers:** Flathead and Phillips.
- **Pliers:** Tongue-and-groove (Channel Locks).
- **Sponge and Bucket:** To remove every drop of water.

- **Flange Wax Ring:** (If replacing the toilet).
- **New Flapper:** (If fixing a leak).
- **Closet Auger:** (For deep clogs).

Chapter 1: The "Running" Toilet Fix

If your toilet runs constantly, you are wasting hundreds of gallons of water a month.

Replacing the Flapper

1. **Turn off the water:** Close the valve behind the toilet.
2. **Flush:** Hold the handle down to empty the tank.
3. **Unhook:** Remove the chain from the handle arm and pop the flapper off the pegs.
4. **Install:** Snap the new flapper onto the pegs and connect the chain.

Pro Tip: Ensure the chain has a tiny bit of slack when the flapper is closed. If it's too tight, the flapper won't seal; if it's too loose, the toilet won't flush properly.

Chapter 2: Clearing Stubborn Clogs

The Right Way to Plunge

Use a **Flange Plunger**—the kind with the extra rubber neck at the bottom.

1. Insert the plunger at an angle to avoid trapping air.
2. Push and pull with short, fast strokes.
3. The vacuum created by pulling up is often more effective than pushing down.

Chapter 3: Installing a Bidet Seat/Attachment

1. **Remove the Seat:** Unscrew the bolts behind the seat.
2. **Install the T-Valve:** Screw the bidet's T-valve onto the bottom of the tank.

3. **Connect Hose:** Connect the water supply to the T-valve, then the small hose to the bidet.
4. **Test:** Turn on the water and check for leaks.

Chapter 4: Full Toilet Replacement

Safety Warning: Porcelain is heavy and sharp if broken. Always lift with your legs and wear gloves.

Installation Steps

1. **Drain & Remove:** Turn off water, drain, and lift the old toilet off the bolts.
2. **Prep Flange:** Scrape away old wax and install new bolts.
3. **Apply Wax:** Place the new wax ring on the bottom of the new toilet.
4. **Set Toilet:** Lower it over the bolts and sit on it to squish the wax seal.
5. **Connect:** Tighten bolts (don't crack the porcelain!) and hook up the water.

Conclusion

Congratulations! You've mastered the throne. You've saved yourself a \$200 service call and made your bathroom a more modern, efficient place. You're no longer at the mercy of your home's plumbing.